

John D. Duncan, III

Phone | (240) 688-7187
Location | Washington, DC
Status | US Citizen

Email | cv@johnduncan.io
Homepage | <https://johnduncan.io>
Github | <https://github.com/johndduncaniii>
Linkedin | <https://linkedin.com/in/johndduncan>

Dear Hiring Team at FINRA,

I'm John Duncan, a senior software engineer who helped scale Quorum Analytics—the best-in-class civic tech and public affairs platform—from a bootstrapped startup to a global company serving over 2,000 clients, including over 50% of the Fortune 100. I thrive on solving ambiguous problems, balancing pragmatism while maintaining high standards. A former coworker once said that “[my] work really embod[ies] the idea that no problem is unsolvable, especially when you seek first to understand.” My natural curiosity drives me to deeply understand systems, leading to clean, efficient, and maintainable code. I'm excited about the opportunity to bring my extensive full-stack expertise to FINRA's team.

At Quorum, I consistently delivered large-scale, cross-functional, and high-impact projects on time and under budget. As a technical lead, I drove growth by consistently solving the team's most complex engineering challenges.

1. **Led large-scale, cross-functional projects:** As technical lead, I designed, implemented, and launched the Quorum PAC Hybrid FEC reporting platform, further expanding Quorum into the \$15M+ PAC software market by integrating Cision's government relations PAC product into Quorum's federal PAC platform. I wrote a majority of the project's backend queries, full-stack search infrastructure, technical design document for one-time and recurring credit card contributions, and technical design document and MVP for the full-stack Dashboard integration. I helped unblock the final launch of the feature by reducing database query latency from 60 seconds to 20 milliseconds and backfill execution time from two weeks to under five seconds.

PAC Hybrid required constant cross-functional communication between engineers, product managers, management, QA engineers, professional services, marketing, and leadership teams to deliver a complex integration under a tight deadline. In addition to the technical research and implementation, this involved coordinating across teams, managing stakeholder expectations, and ensuring consistent communication throughout the development lifecycle.

Other projects of similar scope and complexity are listed in my full CV: <https://johnduncan.io/cv.pdf>.

2. **Thrived in fast-moving environments:** At Quorum, I consistently delivered projects on time and under budget in a high-growth startup environment, often working on multiple initiatives simultaneously. I'm accustomed to adapting quickly to changing requirements and priorities.
3. **Balanced strategic vision with hands-on implementation:** I authored numerous technical design documents (TDDs), conducted user interviews with the design team, and worked closely with the product team to define product requirements documents (PRDs), all while working as a technical lead writing 5k+ commits, authoring 700+ pull requests, conducting over 100+ technical applicant interviews, and performing 1000+ code reviews.
4. **Built and optimized full-stack infrastructure:** As technical lead for multiple flagship products, I developed features that balanced performance and user experience. I've worked extensively with Django, Python, PostgreSQL, SQL, JavaScript, and TypeScript, enabling me to understand the architectural considerations necessary to create beautiful, performant, accessible, scalable, and maintainable web experiences.
5. **Created reusable UI components:** I collaborated with our design team and founded the full-stack guild in order to write Quorum's first design system while working on the Dashboard visualization project, creating modular, reusable widgets and visualization components which maintain consistency and performance across the platform while improving developer efficiency.

A portion of my major work at Quorum is highlighted in my portfolio: <https://johnduncan.io/portfolio#quorum>.

I'm particularly drawn to FINRA's mission of protecting investors and its commitment to creating vibrant capital markets since my mother, Vickie R. Olafson, worked as an appellate attorney in FINRA's Office of General Counsel for fourteen years and highly recommended FINRA as an employer. I am particularly interested in helping foster a kind and thoughtful team culture and believe that my combination of technical expertise, leadership experience, ability to work effectively with cross-functional stakeholders, and expertise in leading projects from conception to execution makes me an ideal candidate for this position.

I'm excited about the opportunity to apply my skills to help scale FINRA's engineering team and contribute to the company's continued growth. I would love to discuss how my background aligns with the position and how I can help drive FINRA's engineering team forward.

Thank you for considering my application!

Sincerely,

John D. Duncan, III